First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office:
M: 10-12, **Tu**: 9-2, **W**: 10-12, **Th**: 9-12 & 1-5, **F**: 10-12
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Monday is Pastor Jessica's Sabbath.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Reader: Louise Haynes
Acolytes: Mykala Pryor & Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans
An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:
July 28, 2024
10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Tenth Sunday After Pentecost July 28, 2024

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words:
"Great ideas emerge from useless fragments of thoughts." — Michael Bassey Johnson

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude

Welcome and Announcements

Call To Worship

One: Within this community

All: We experience God's unconditional love

One: Within this community

All: We rejoice in the risen Christ

One: Within this community

All: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

One: Within this community

All: We join together in worship

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

Great and Mighty God, we seek your presence among us. We strain to hear your voice as it so often gets drowned out by the noise of the world. We pause to consider your works, your word, and your way. Speak to us now in spirit and in truth. Open your hand and our hearts that we may join in this moment of holy encounter. Forge us as a community committed to follow the path Jesus has marked for us. Amen.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- ★ Maria Barresi, Rachael Carr, Paula Kane, Park Newton, Greg Beeman- Thank you for representing FCC at the Kingman Car Show.
- ★ Doug Klette, Kent Gramm - Thank you for Preaching while Pastor Jessica is on vacation.

Franklin County Field Days
We are looking for 'DeLorean' raffle ticket sellers at the fair. There will be a sign-up sheet available at coffee hour. Sign up times are for Aug. 1-4, timing from 12-6pm.

July 29 - August 17
Pastor Jessica's Vacation - Rev. Preston Fuller will be providing emergency pastoral care (802) 524-5632.

Breakfast Club
August 10 @9am St. Albans Diner
RSVP Sue Brown– (802)527-6336

Online Giving:

Wi-Fi:
Sanctuary
sanctuary123



HYMN*

"Immortal, Invisible, God Only Wise" (1,2,4) NCH 1

PRAYER OF CONFESSION[1] **(UNISON)**

Creator God, we confess that we fail to recognize the bounty around us. We are not satisfied; we never have enough. We consider what we have received and what we have generated, and label is too little rather than sufficient. We need to cultivate our imagination and our faith to observe abundance and opportunity rather than scarcity and deficiency. Help us to comprehend that, in your kin-dom, the fragments you gather are more than enough for flourishing.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

SPECIAL MUSIC *Accordion and Bayan Music*

SCRIPTURE READING John 6:1-21

MORNING REFLECTION

I Believe in Miracles . . . since you came along

HYMN*

"Let Us Break Bread Together" NCH 330

THE COMMUNION

One: The invitation is simple: come and eat of the feast. Not a meal to nourish the body, but to feed the soul. We receive the bread and juice connected to the ages: to the saint of old who felt unworthy, to the seeker eager to know God, to the one who wonders what it's all about, to the one who eats with unburdened faith. Woven into this time are the hopes and tears of generations. There is great joy here. No one is turned away for God is the host! May the peace of the Lord be with you always.

All: And also with you.
One: Lift up your hearts.
All: We lift them up to the Lord.
One: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.
All: It is right to give God thanks and praise.

Pause

All: Loving God, recalling Christ's gracious life and death, and proclaiming the resurrection, we offer this bread and cup. Send your Holy Spirit upon us and upon these gifts, that they may be for us the body and blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, and being built up by this precious sacrament of grace, we may receive the gift of eternal life in the blessed and heavenly realm.

One: We ask this in the name of Jesus Christ, praying the prayer taught to the disciples:

All: Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil, for thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever. Amen.

One: Gathered with his friends, Jesus took bread, broke it and said, "This is my body, broken for you. Take and eat."
And Jesus took the juice and said, "This is my blood, spilled out for you. Do this in remembrance of me."

Distribution of the Bread and Cup: please hold your cup until we serve all, so that all may drink together.

One: Let us pray.

All: Gracious God, we thank you for refreshing us at your table. May we who share Christ's bread live his risen life. May we who drink Christ's cup bring abundant life to others. May the Holy Spirit who lights the world also enlighten our lives. Strengthen in us the hope you set before us, so that we and all your children shall be free, and so that the whole earth may live to praise your name. Amen.

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Pastor's Prayer~

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"Spirit, Spirit of Gentleness" (1,2) NCH 286

Benediction

Postlude

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖